Lab - System Utilities

Introduction

In this lab, you will use Windows utilities to configure operating system settings.

Recommended Equipment

- A computer running Windows

Instructions

Part 1: Custom Management Console

Step 1: Explore the management console.

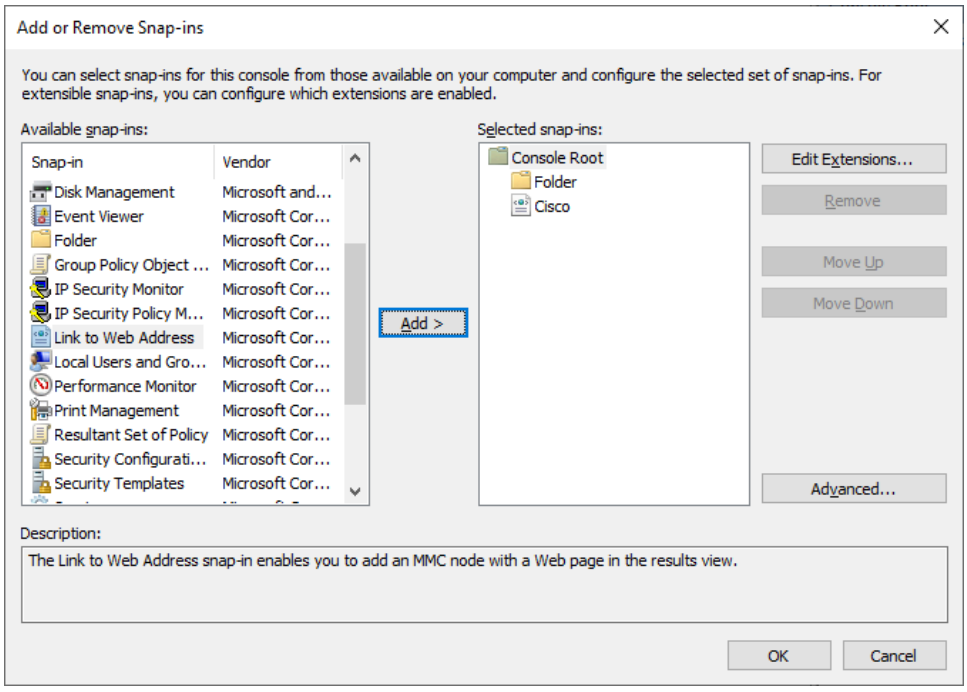
a. To open the Microsoft Management Console, click **Start**, and search for **mmc**. Click **Yes** to allow Microsoft Management Console to make changes to the computer.

b. In the **Console1 - [Console Root]** window, you can build a custom console. Click **File > Add/Remove Snap-in**.

c. In the **Add or Remove Snap-ins** window, you can add a folder snap-in. Scroll down the Available snap-ins: pane to locate the **Folder** snap-in. Select **Folder** and click **Add>**.

d. To add the **Link to Web Address** snap-in, scroll down the Available snap-ins: pane and select **Link to Web Address**. Click **Add>**. In the **Link to Web Address** wizard window, enter http://www.cisco.com in the **Path or URL:** field, click **Next>** to continue.

e. In the Friendly name for the Link to Web Address snap-in box, enter Cisco and click Finish to continue.



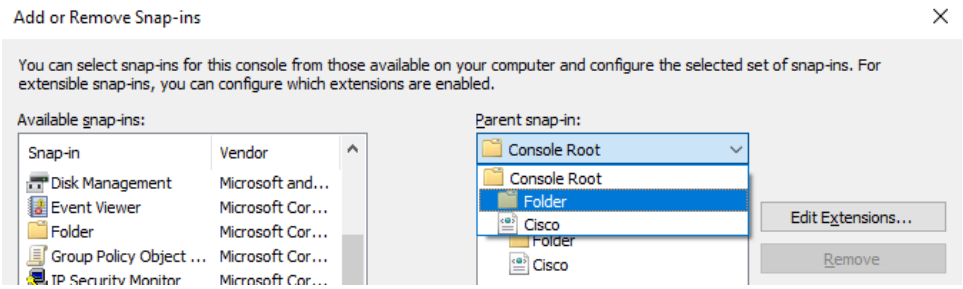
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Step 2: Create a custom management console.

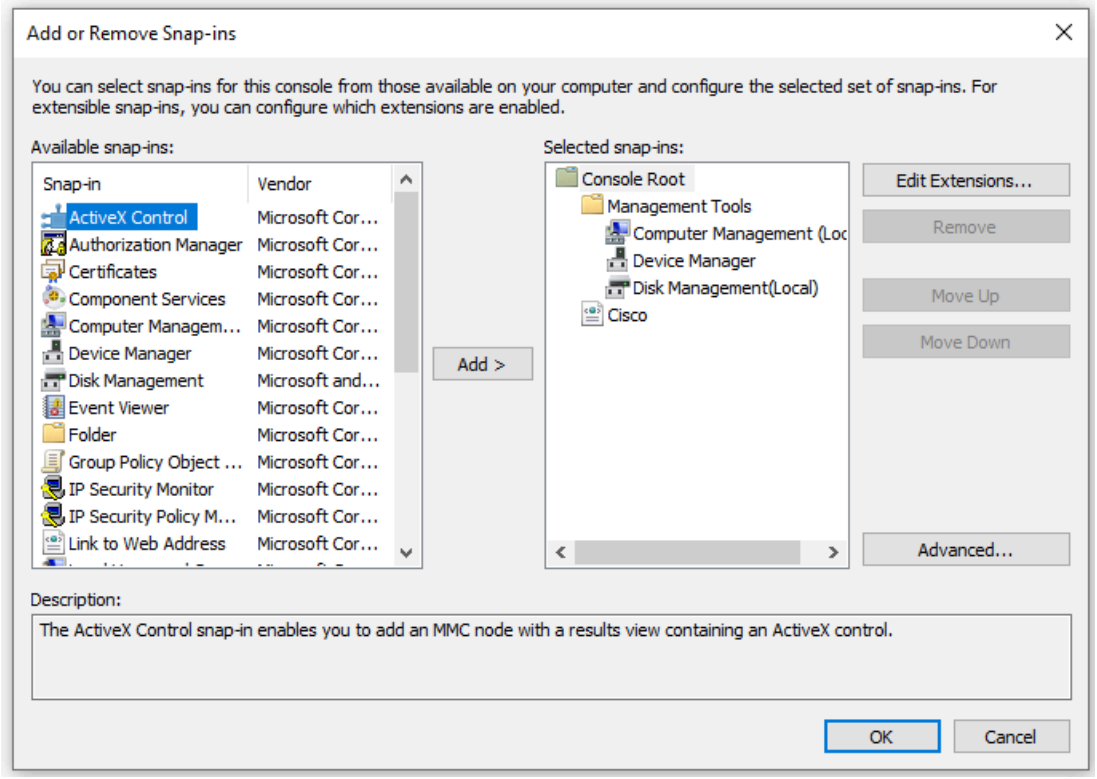
a. To add snap-ins to the folder snap-in, click **Advanced**.

b. The Advanced window opens. Select Allow changing the parent snap-in. Click OK.

c. A drop-down menu appears for **Parent snap-in**. In the **Parent snap-in** box, select **Folder**.



d. Add the following snap-ins from the Available snap-in: pane: **Computer Management**, **Device Manager**, and **Disk Management**. In each of the snap-in windows, click **Finish** to select to use the snap-in to manage the Local Computer or This computer.



e. Click **OK** to continue to exit the Add or Remove Snap-ins window.

f. In the **Console1** window, right-click the **Folder** icon and select **Rename**. Change the name of the folder to **Management Tools**.

g. To save the custom console, click **File > Save As**. Change the file name to your name. Example: **John's Console**. Change the **Save in** box to **Desktop**. Click **Save**.

h. Close all open windows.

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i. On the desktop, double-click the **Console** icon that contains your name to re-open the console with your snap-ins. Click **Yes** to allow this application to make changes to your device as necessary.

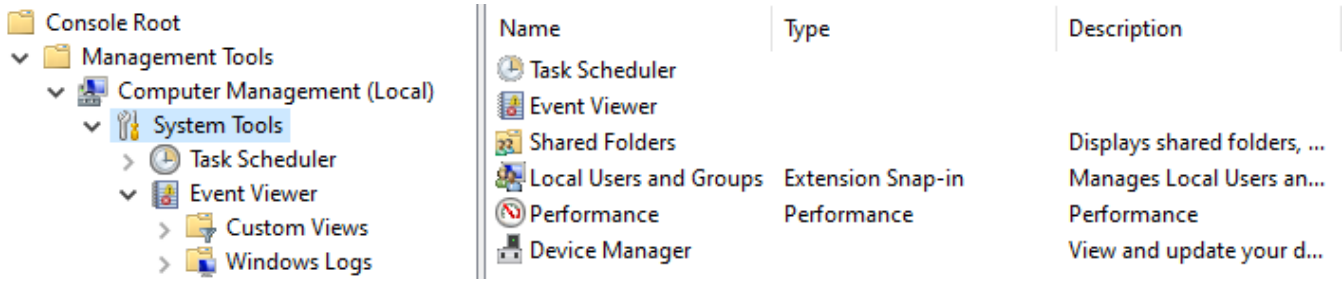
j. Review the **Management Tools** folder by double-clicking on the tools.

k. Within your custom console, navigate to the Event Viewer.

Question:

What was the path you use to navigate to the Event Viewer?

Management Tools > Computer Management > Event Viewer



l. Close the **Console** window when you finish your review. Click **No** when prompted to save the changes.

Part 2: Registry Editor

Step 1: Change your desktop background settings.

a. Right-click the Desktop > select **Personalize**.

Question:

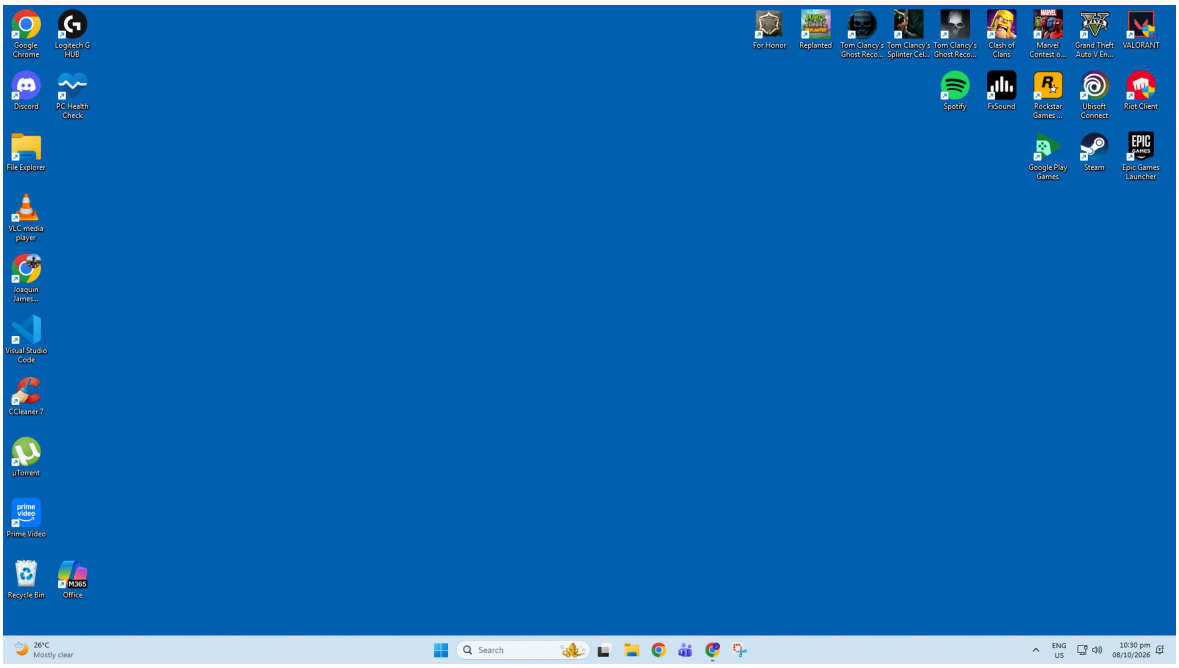
What is the background picture?

Dr Strange (Marvel)



b. In Windows 10, select **Solid color** in the Background drop-down list. Choose a **blue** background color.

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In Windows 8.1 and 7, click **Desktop Background**. Select **Solid Colors** in the Picture Location drop-down list. Choose a **blue** background color.

c. Click **Save changes**. The computer screen should now have a blue background. If not, ask the instructor for assistance.

d. Close all open windows.

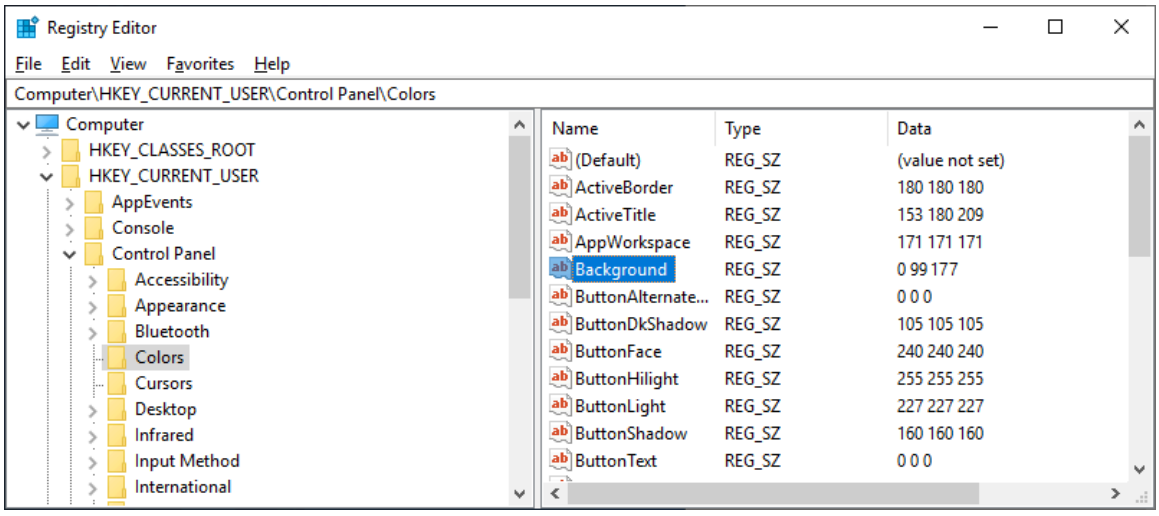
Step 2: Open the registry editor.

a. To open the **Registry Editor**, click **Start** and type **regedit**. Click **Yes** to allow Registry Editor to make changes to the computer.

Note: Do not make any changes in the Registry Editor without instructor permission.

b. Select and expand the **HKEY_CURRENT_USER** entry.

c. Expand **Control Panel**. Click **Colors**. Click **Background** in the right panel.



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Question:

What is the data value of the Background (hint – it has three numbers that correspond to red, green, and blue)?

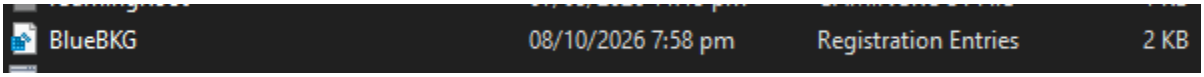
0 0 255

Step 3: Export a registry key.

You will export the **HKEY_CURRENT_USER\Control Panel\Colors** folder.

a. In the left pane, select the **Colors** folder and click **File > Export**.

b. Save the file to the Desktop with the name **BlueBKG**.



c. At the desktop, right-click the **BlueBKG.reg** icon and select **Edit**.

d. Notepad opens displaying the contents of **BlueBKG.reg**.

Question:

What is the data value of the **Background**?

0 0 255

e. Close the **BlueBKG.reg – Notepad** window.

f. Open the Personalization window by right-clicking the **Desktop > Personalize > Desktop Background**. Select a **red** background color.

g. Click **Save** changes. Close the **Personalization** window.

h. The desktop background should be red. Click the **Registry Editor** window.

i. On your keyboard, press **F5** to refresh the **Registry Editor** window.

Question:

What is the data value of the Background? Compare the new value in the Registry to the value saved in BlueBKG.reg.

255 0 0

Step 4: Import a registry file.

You will import the **BlueBKG.reg** file to change the Desktop ground back to blue.

a. Click the **Registry Editor** window.

b. Click **File** > **Import**. Locate and click the **BlueBKG.reg** file then click **Open**.

c. The **Registry Editor** informational message opens letting you know that keys and values have been successfully added to the registry. Click **OK**.

d. Select the **Registry Editor** window.

Questions:

What is the data value of the Background?

0 0 255

What is the color of the desktop?

Blue

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e. Restart the computer.

Question:

What is the color of the desktop?

Blue

f. Reset **Display Properties Background** to the original settings.

g. Close all open windows.

h. Delete the custom console and BlueBKG file on the desktop.

Reflection Question

1. Why would it be beneficial to add snap-ins to the mmc that are for other computers on the network?

   It allows an administrator to manage and troubleshoot other computers on the network from one computer. This saves time and makes network management easier.

2. After restarting the computer, why was the desktop color changed?

   The desktop color changed because the registry settings were imported from the BlueBKG.reg file. The file restored the blue background setting in the registry.

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Help

```
C:\Users\user>help
For more information on a specific command, type HELP command-name
ASSOC          Displays or modifies file extension associations.
ATTRIB         Displays or changes file attributes.
BREAK          Sets or clears extended CTRL+C checking.
BCDEDIT        Sets properties in boot database to control boot loading.
CACLS          Displays or modifies access control lists (ACLs) of files.
CALL           Calls one batch program from another.
CD             Displays the name of or changes the current directory.
CHCP           Displays or sets the active code page number.
CHDIR          Displays the name of or changes the current directory.
CHKDSK         Checks a disk and displays a status report.
CHKNTFS        Displays or modifies the checking of disk at boot time.
CLS            Clears the screen.
CMD            Starts a new instance of the Windows command interpreter.
COLOR          Sets the default console foreground and background colors.
COMP           Compares the contents of two files or sets of files.
COMPACT        Displays or alters the compression of files on NTFS partitions.
CONVERT        Converts FAT volumes to NTFS.  You cannot convert the
               current drive.
COPY           Copies one or more files to another location.
DATE           Displays or sets the date.
DEL            Deletes one or more files.
DIR            Displays a list of files and subdirectories in a directory.
DISKPART       Displays or configures Disk Partition properties.
DOSKEY         Edits command lines, recalls Windows commands, and
               creates macros.
```

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Command /?

```
C:\Users\user>dir /?
Displays a list of files and subdirectories in a directory.

DIR [drive:][path][filename] [/A[[:]attributes]] [/B] [/C] [/D] [/L] [/N]
  [/O[[:]sortorder]] [/P] [/Q] [/R] [/S] [/T[[:]timefield]] [/W] [/X] [/4]

  [drive:][path][filename]
              Specifies drive, directory, and/or files to list.

  /A          Displays files with specified attributes.
  attributes   D  Directories                R  Read-only files
               H  Hidden files               A  Files ready for archiving
               S  System files               I  Not content indexed files
               L  Reparse Points             O  Offline files
               -  Prefix meaning not
  /B          Uses bare format (no heading information or summary).
  /C          Display the thousand separator in file sizes.  This is the
              default.  Use /-C to disable display of separator.
  /D          Same as wide but files are list sorted by column.
  /L          Uses lowercase.
  /N          New long list format where filenames are on the far right.
  /O          List by files in sorted order.
  sortorder    N  By name (alphabetic)       S  By size (smallest first)
               E  By extension (alphabetic)  D  By date/time (oldest first)
               G  Group directories first    -  Prefix to reverse order
  /P          Pauses after each screenful of information.
  /Q          Display the owner of the file.
  /R          Display alternate data streams of the file.
  /S          Displays files in specified directory and all subdirectories.
  /T          Controls which time field displayed or used for sorting
```

Cls

```
C:\Users\user>cls /?
Clears the screen.

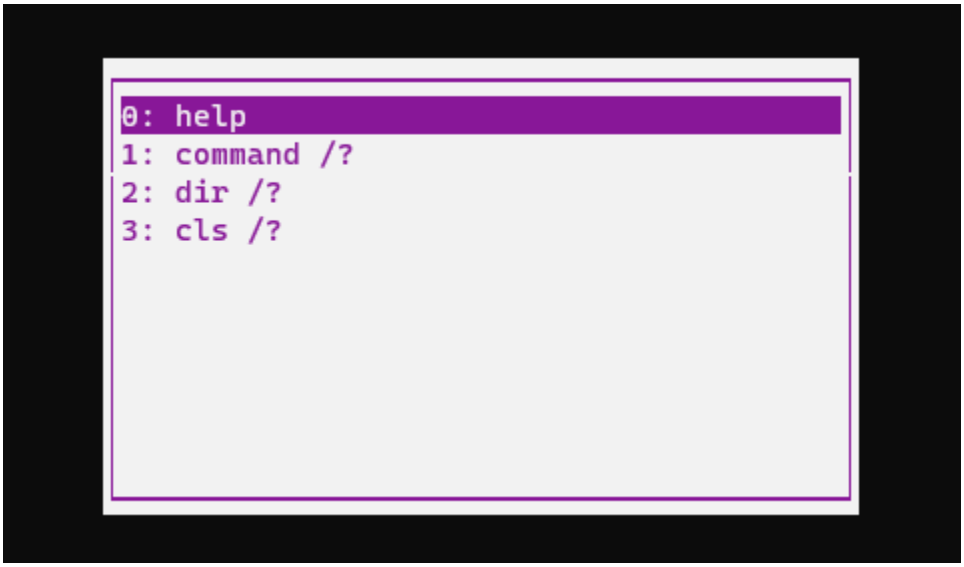
CLS
```

Up-arrow key

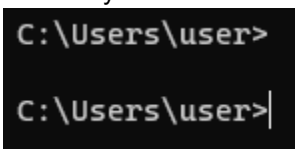
```
C:\Users\user>help
```

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F7 Key



Crtl C keys



Exit



Reflections and learnings:
This lab helped me understand how Windows system utilities work and how they can be used to manage a computer. I learned how to create a custom MMC console, navigate through Event Viewer, and use the Registry Editor to save and restore settings. It was a simple but interesting experience because I got to see how small changes in the system can affect the computer. Overall, I learned that being careful and organized when working with system settings is important.

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